MOCK TEST

ACADEMIC TEST

MT-01

LISTENING

SECTION 1

LUCY: Alright, let's try to get everything settled today so we don't leave it hanging, yeah?

TOM: Sounds good. I'll take care of the notes.

LUCY: First up, numbers... are we sure about them?

TOM: I've been checking and I think we're looking at around 40 to 55.

LUCY: Maybe we should put 60 just to be on the safe side?

TOM: Yeah, that works.

LUCY: Now, dates... anything firm on that front?

TOM: The last working day before New Year's... which is...

LUCY: ...December 29th.

TOM: That'll be tricky to book around the holidays, so we should have a couple of backup options.

LUCY: Last year's place was awful.

TOM: The Blue Swan, right?

LUCY: Yeah. We should aim for somewhere a bit fancier this time.

TOM: I agree... you get what you pay for.

LUCY: There's a new Italian restaurant in town, La Dolce Vita. I've heard great things about it.

TOM: How do you spell that?

LUCY: L-A D-O-L-C-E V-I-T-A.

TOM: But it's probably going to be packed.

LUCY: Let's put that as our top choice, then we can have backups. How about The Grand Hotel for second choice?

TOM: Yeah, it's reliable. The Grand Hotel.

LUCY: And The Royal Arms for third?

TOM: The Royal Arms...

LUCY: I'll call them now if you want.

TOM: No, I'll handle it. You're swamped already. Do you have the numbers?

LUCY: I don't have La Dolce Vita's, but... okay, The Grand Hotel: 5551234 and The Royal Arms: 5678901.

TOM: Great. Before I make the calls, we should double-check they fit within the budget.

LUCY: £20 per person?

TOM: Some people might not be able to stretch that far.

LUCY: Well, you can't get anything decent under £15.

TOM: Alright, £18 then.

LUCY: Perfect.

TOM: And we should make sure there's a good selection of vegetarian options.

LUCY: And a no-smoking area! You know how sensitive Peter is about that.

TOM: Don't remind me! I'll get back to you as soon as I have updates.

TOM: Great news, Lucy. I found La Dolce Vita's number and they can accommodate us. Their Christmas menu looks amazing.

LUCY: What's on it?

TOM: Tomato soup or mixed fruit juice.

LUCY: Sounds good.

TOM: For the main, it's either roast turkey or vegetarian lasagna.

LUCY: Lasagna's an interesting choice.

TOM: Then for dessert, we have pudding or tiramisu, plus coffee.

LUCY: Wow, all that for £18? Did you secure the booking?

TOM: I told them I'd check with everyone first. But they said they'd hold the spot until next Wednesday. Also, if we confirm, they'll need a £60 deposit.

LUCY: £60 is standard, that's fine.

TOM: They also want a confirmation letter.

LUCY: Okay, I'll sort that out.

TOM: And because of the size of the group, we have to decide on the menu in advance.

LUCY: No problem. I'll put a notice up about the menu. When do they need the confirmation?

TOM: By the 5th of December.

LUCY: Where should I post the notice where everyone will definitely see it?

TOM: Maybe the staff kitchen?

LUCY: Hardly anyone checks there.

TOM: The staff newsletter is probably the best option.

LUCY: Good idea. I'll get that sorted now.

COMPLETE THE NOTES BELOW

Write NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND / OR A NUMBER for each answer.

- Expected attendees between 40 and **1.** ____.
- The event will take place on **2.** ____, before new year's
- The first venue choice is **3.** _____.
- The backup venue is **4.** ____.
- The price per person is up to **5.** _____.
- Main course **6.** _____
- Dessert options **7.** _____ or ____ plus coffee.
- deposit **8.** ____ is required.
- Confirmation by **9.** ____
- The notice will be posted on **10.** _____ .

SECTION 2

Hello, everyone, and thank you for coming to this informal meeting about the University Helpline. The Helpline was established ten years ago by the Students' Union, and its purpose is to provide new students with a service that can assist them with any practical aspects of university life they might be unfamiliar with.

Let me give you a few examples of the kind of help we offer. One of the areas we assist with is financial matters. For instance, if you feel that your grant isn't enough to cover your expenses during your time at university or if you have questions about the fees you're paying—particularly if you're an international student—the Helpline can help by going through these matters with you and offering advice on possible solutions.

Another area we help with is what we refer to as 'domestic' issues, such as childcare or nursery provision. If you're a student with children, we can guide you to the appropriate resources and answer any questions you might have regarding this area.

We also support students with academic issues that may come up, especially during the early stages of your course. For example, you may have questions about essay deadlines or how to access resources in the library. There are a lot of questions you might find yourself asking that can be difficult to get answers for, and the Helpline is here to provide that assistance.

Lastly, we deal with 'social' matters. University life isn't just about studying, and we understand that building a social life is just as important. If you're looking for ways to get involved in social activities, such as joining clubs or participating in trips and outings, the Helpline can point you in the right direction.

Now, let me give you some details so you know where to find us. The main contact person for the Helpline is Jackie Kouachi, that's K-O-U-A-C-H-I. Jackie is a full-time staff member of the Student Union, and she works in the Student Welfare Office, which handles all welfare-related matters for students. The office is located at 13 Marshall Road. If you haven't been there yet, I've got some maps here to help you find it.

If you prefer to call, the office number is 326 99 40. That's 3269940. The office is open weekdays from 9:30 a.m. to 6:00 p.m., and on Saturdays from 10:00 a.m. to 4:00 p.m. Usually, Jackie or I will be available during those hours. If you need to make an appointment, you can either call us or drop by the office in person. Please keep in mind that during busy times, such as lunch hours, there may be a waiting list, and we may not be able to see you immediately.

That's all I have for now. Any questions?

COMPLETE THE NOTES BELOW

Write NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS AND / OR A NUMBER for each answer.

Form 1: University Helpline Details

Established by **11.** _____

Helpline purpose: assist with **12.** _____

Financial matters: Advice on **13.** _____

Domestic issues: Children or **14.** _____

Academic issues **15.** _____

Social Activities: **16.** _____ or participating in trips

Main contact person **17.** _____

Office location **18.** 13_____ road.

Weekdays opening: **19.** _____

Weekdays closing: 6:00 pm

Saturday opening: 10:00 am

Saturday closing: **20.** _____

SECTION 3

TUTOR:

Good morning, everyone. Today, we'll be discussing the importance of teamwork and collaboration in modern work environments. Over the past few weeks, we've looked at various aspects of organizational structures and management styles. Now, we're going to focus on how team dynamics impact productivity and success. We'll also examine how different personalities and working styles can either enhance or hinder a team's effectiveness.

SARAH:

So, are we going to talk about the different roles within a team today? How people contribute to a team in different ways?

TUTOR:

Exactly, Sarah. We'll start by considering the different roles that people play within a team. Some team members are natural leaders, others are excellent at organizing tasks, while some are more analytical and focus on problem-solving. It's important to recognize how these roles complement each other and how a team functions best when members work together in harmony.

JAMES:

Right. So, it's not just about individual talent, but how well we work together as a group?

TUTOR:

Yes, that's correct, James. Individual talent is valuable, but when people work in teams, the goal is to leverage each person's strengths. It's not enough to have a team of high-achieving individuals if they can't cooperate and communicate effectively. You need to consider how people's personalities, skills, and work styles align with the goals of the team. For instance, some people thrive in collaborative environments, while others may prefer to work independently.

JAMES:

That sounds a bit challenging. How do you ensure that team members are placed in the right roles?

TUTOR:

Good question, James. One way to approach this is through something known as "team role theory." It suggests that people naturally gravitate toward specific roles in a team based on their personality traits. Some may be "planners," who enjoy organizing tasks and setting deadlines. Others may be "innovators," who come up with creative ideas and solutions. Understanding these roles can help managers allocate tasks more effectively and ensure that everyone is working in a way that suits them best.

SARAH:

So, it's about recognizing people's strengths and weaknesses, and then using that information to form a balanced team?

TUTOR:

Exactly. And it's not just about filling roles—it's about creating a team dynamic where people can challenge each other, offer different perspectives, and support one another. The best teams are those that combine a variety of skills and perspectives, and where everyone feels valued. However, it's important to note that conflict can arise when people have conflicting working styles. That's why communication and conflict resolution skills are so crucial in team settings.

JAMES:

And do you think that some people are just naturally better at working in teams?

TUTOR:

There's definitely a natural element to it. Some people are born collaborators, while others may need more time to adjust to group work. However, with the right training and experience, most people can improve their ability to work in teams. That's why many organizations place such an emphasis on teamwork skills during the recruitment and selection process. For example, companies often use group exercises during interviews to see how candidates perform in a team environment.

SARAH:

So, team building isn't just about picking the right people—it's also about creating an environment where teamwork can thrive?

TUTOR:

Exactly, Sarah. It's about fostering a culture where collaboration is encouraged, and team members are supported. That's why many companies invest in team-building activities and workshops to improve communication, trust, and problem-solving within their teams. These activities help people get to know each other better and develop the interpersonal skills that are necessary for effective teamwork.

JAMES:

It sounds like a lot of work, but definitely worth it.

TUTOR:

Absolutely. In the long run, investing in a strong team culture leads to greater productivity, innovation, and job satisfaction. Remember, a great team can achieve much more than the sum of its parts. But it requires a combination of the right people, the right roles, and the right environment.

SARAH:

I’m starting to see how all of this fits together now. It’s not just about being good at the job—it’s about how you interact with others and contribute to the team’s overall success.

TUTOR:

Exactly! And with that in mind, let's move on to some real-world examples of team dynamics and explore how different companies handle these challenges. Any questions before we continue?

Choose the correct Letter A, B, C, or D

21. What is the main focus of today's discussion?

A) The importance of individual talent in a team

B) The impact of teamwork and collaboration on productivity

C) How to recruit the best team members

D) The role of leadership in teams

22. Which of the following best describes the purpose of team role theory?

A) It suggests that people naturally gravitate toward specific roles based on their personality traits.

B) It focuses on individual performance rather than team dynamics.

C) It is used to identify the best team leaders.

D) It helps individuals improve their communication skills.

23. According to the tutor, what is essential for a team to function well?

A) High individual talent

B) A balance of different personalities and skills

C) Clear leadership

D) Efficient task delegation

24. What can lead to conflict in teams, according to the tutor?

A) Working independently

B) Having too many planners

C) Conflicting working styles

D) A lack of task delegation

25. How can individuals improve their ability to work in teams?

A) By attending interviews and group exercises

B) Through training and experience

C) By working independently for a while

D) By focusing solely on their individual skills

26. What do many companies invest in to improve teamwork?

A) Hiring more team members

B) Team-building activities and workshops

C) Increased communication technology

D) Individual performance reviews

27. What does the tutor suggest is one of the natural roles that team members may take on?

A) Innovators who come up with creative solutions

B) Managers who organize and lead teams

C) Designers who focus on aesthetics

D) Workers who complete repetitive tasks

28. According to the tutor, what role do conflict resolution skills play in teamwork?

A) They help solve technical problems.

B) They are crucial for managing differing working styles.

C) They ensure that all team members are in agreement.

D) They focus on increasing productivity.

29. What does Sarah realize by the end of the discussion?

A) Teamwork is not as important as individual work.

B) Team dynamics affect job performance and success.

C) A good leader is more important than a good team.

D) Communication skills are irrelevant in teamwork.

30. What is the ultimate benefit of fostering a strong team culture, according to the tutor?

A) Greater individual achievements

B) Greater productivity, innovation, and job satisfaction

C) More opportunities for promotions

D) Higher team turnover rates

SECTION 4

TUTOR:

Good afternoon, everyone. Before we begin today's lecture, I'd like to remind you that we will be discussing an important concept in the field of education: the role of project-based learning in developing students' practical and creative skills. Specifically, we'll look at Vivien's hat-making project, which she carried out during her teaching practice in a secondary school in London. Let's dive into the details of how this project worked and what we can learn from it. Vivien, over to you.

VIVIEN:

Thanks, Mr. Yardley. So, as Mr. Yardley mentioned, I was a student teacher at a secondary school in London for six weeks. During my placement, I had the opportunity to teach a variety of subjects to a class of fourteen-year-old students. For this particular project, I chose to do something creative—hat-making. The reason I selected this project was because I believe it can easily be adapted to suit different age groups, from younger students to adults.

Let me explain the project. After conducting research into different types of hats, we moved on to the practical phase in the classroom. The first task was to create two basic hat shapes using rolls of old wallpaper. The first hat was a simple conical shape. To make this, I had the students cut out a circle from the wallpaper, make one cut up to the center, and then overlap the cut to form a cone. This type of hat sits comfortably on the head. The second hat we made was slightly more complex—a pillbox hat. We started by cutting out another circle and then added a long strip of paper with flaps that were bent over and glued to the underside of the circle. This step required a bit more care, especially when it came to using glue, so I always made sure to cover the tables to prevent any mess.

TUTOR:

That sounds like a very creative approach. How did the students respond to these activities?

VIVIEN:

The students really enjoyed this hands-on process. Once the basic hat shapes were created, we moved on to the design phase, where students were encouraged to use their research to sketch their hat ideas. The key challenge here was translating their two-dimensional designs into three-dimensional forms that would fit on their heads. I asked them to start with a small-scale version to experiment with different shapes before committing to the final design.

To keep the project manageable, I imposed certain constraints. For example, students could only use paper, not card, because paper is more flexible and easier to shape. I also limited the color palette to shades of white, grey, and brown to reflect the colors of the buildings they were drawing inspiration from. One important rule was that the glue had to be invisible in the final design, so they had to be very careful with application.

The results were fantastic. I've brought along three examples to show you. The first is a design by Theresa, which features three pillbox hats stacked on top of one another, inspired by a circular stairway in an old London building. The second hat, made by Muriel, uses a simple strip around the base but has additional strips of paper that extend upward, forming a crown-like structure. The final hat, created by Fabrice, combines a pillbox base with a conical shape on top to create a tower-like structure resembling a castle turret.

TUTOR:

Thank you for sharing these examples, Vivien. It's clear that the students were highly engaged and produced some very creative results. So, what can we take away from this project?

VIVIEN:

One key takeaway is the importance of encouraging students to work both individually and collaboratively in creative projects. The process of making something tangible allowed the students to apply their research and ideas in a practical way. The constraints I imposed helped them focus on technique and design, while also encouraging problem-solving skills. Moreover, this type of project-based learning can be easily adapted to different educational contexts and can help develop both technical skills and creative thinking.

TUTOR:

Exactly. The project demonstrates the value of integrating creativity and practical tasks into education. It's not just about the end product but also about the learning journey—developing skills such as planning, problem-solving, and critical thinking. Additionally, by limiting the resources and setting constraints, Vivien encouraged her students to think outside the box and use their imagination within a structured framework.

In terms of educational theory, this project ties into the concept of constructivism, where students actively build their understanding through hands-on experiences. This method also supports experiential learning, where students learn by doing, making the content more meaningful and memorable.

So, thank you, Vivien, for sharing this insightful project with us. It's a great example of how project-based learning can be used to foster creativity, problem-solving, and critical thinking in students. Now, let's open the floor for any questions.

COMPLETE THE SENTENCE BELOW

Write NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS for each answer.

31. Vivien carried out her project during her teaching practice at a _____ school in London.

32. The students created two basic hat shapes using rolls of _____.

33. The first step to make the conical hat involved cutting out a circle and making a cut to form a _____.

34. The pillbox hat required more attention, particularly when it came to applying _____ to the design.

35. The students' designs were inspired by their research, where they had to translate _____ designs into three-dimensional forms.

36. To maintain flexibility, Vivien allowed only _____ to be used for the hats.

37. The project had a color restriction, limiting it to _____, grey, and brown.

38. One of the key rules for the project was that the _____ had to be invisible in the final design.

39. The project emphasized both practical techniques and the development of _____ skills among the students.

40. Vivien's project-based learning aligns with the concept of _____, where students learn through hands-on activities.

READING

PASSAGE 1

The Ecosystem of Coral Reefs

Coral reefs are among the most biologically diverse ecosystems on the planet, often referred to as the "rainforests of the sea." These vibrant underwater structures are essential for marine life, providing food, shelter, and breeding grounds for countless species. Despite covering less than 1% of the ocean floor, coral reefs support an estimated 25% of all marine life. Found in tropical and subtropical oceans, reefs extend across some 250,000 square kilometers globally.

Corals are marine invertebrates that belong to the phylum Cnidaria. They are colonial organisms, meaning that they form large colonies of individual polyps. Each polyp secretes calcium carbonate, which forms the hard exoskeleton of the reef. Coral reefs are built over centuries as polyps grow and multiply, forming complex structures that provide habitats for numerous species of fish, mollusks, crustaceans, and algae.

The biodiversity of coral reefs is staggering. In addition to their role in supporting marine life, reefs protect coastlines by absorbing the energy from waves and storms, thereby preventing coastal erosion and reducing the impact of tsunamis. Coral reefs also contribute significantly to global economies, particularly through tourism and fishing. It is estimated that coral reefs generate approximately $375 billion annually from tourism, fisheries, and other services such as coastal protection.

The Role of Symbiosis in Coral Reef Survival

Coral reefs owe much of their existence to a unique symbiotic relationship between corals and zooxanthellae, microscopic algae that live inside coral tissues. The algae perform photosynthesis, providing corals with essential nutrients, while corals provide the protection and access to sunlight to algae. This mutually beneficial relationship allows coral reefs to thrive in nutrient-poor waters, making them highly sensitive to environmental disturbances.

Corals also rely on zooxanthellae for their striking colors. The algae give the corals their vibrant hues, which is why coral reefs are often described as "rainforests of the sea." In return, corals provide the algae with the carbon dioxide and nitrogen they need for photosynthesis. Without this symbiotic relationship, coral reefs would be unable to support the diverse range of species that depend on them.

However, this relationship is fragile. Coral reefs are highly sensitive to changes in environmental conditions such as sea temperature, pollution, and ocean acidification. Even small temperature increases can cause corals to expel their algae, a phenomenon known as coral bleaching.

The Threats to Coral Reefs

Climate change is the biggest threat facing coral reefs today. Rising global temperatures have resulted in more frequent and intense coral bleaching events. When water temperatures rise by just 1-2°C above normal, corals expel their zooxanthellae, losing their color and energy source. Without the algae, corals become weak and more vulnerable to diseases. If bleaching persists for long periods, corals may die, leading to the collapse of entire reef ecosystems.

Ocean acidification is another significant threat. Increased carbon dioxide in the atmosphere is absorbed by the oceans, leading to a decrease in pH levels. This makes it harder for corals to secrete calcium carbonate, weakening their skeletal structures. In addition to climate change, human activities such as overfishing, pollution, and coastal development further contribute to the degradation of coral reefs.

Conservation Efforts and Solutions

Several efforts are underway to protect and conserve coral reefs. Marine protected areas (MPAs) have been established around the world to safeguard coral reefs from harmful human activities such as fishing and coastal development. These protected zones allow coral ecosystems to recover and thrive without the added stress of human interference.

Coral restoration projects, such as coral farming, are another promising solution. In these projects, corals are grown in controlled environments, and fragments of these corals are transplanted back into damaged reefs. Though these efforts have had varying degrees of success, they offer hope for the restoration of coral ecosystems.

Additionally, public awareness campaigns are essential to the protection of coral reefs. Educating the public about sustainable practices, such as reducing plastic waste, using reef-safe sunscreens, and supporting sustainable seafood, can help mitigate the damage done to coral ecosystems. Governments and NGOs are working together to promote these practices on a global scale.

COMPLETE THE NOTES BELOW

Write NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS for each answer.

1. Often called the “rainforests of the sea,” coral reefs are one of the planet's richest biologically varying ecosystems.
2. The phylum Cnidaria includes the marine invertebrates known as corals.
3. The reef's strong exoskeleton is made of calcium carbonate secreted by each polyp.
4. Reefs and marine life shield coastlines by absorbing storm and wave energy, which stops coastal erosion and lessens the threat of tsunamis.
5. An estimated $375 billion is made by coral reefs each year from tourism, fishing, and other services like protecting the shoreline.

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the text

TURE	**if the statement agrees with the information**
FALSE	**if the statement contradicts with the information**
NOT GIVEN	**if there is no information on this**

6. Coral and zooxanthellae have a symbiotic interaction that is largely responsible for the life of coral reefs.
7. Corals are protected and given access to sunlight by zooxanthellae
8. Events of coral bleaching are occurring increasingly often as a result of rising global temperatures.
9. If coral bleaching persists for a long time, the corals can bounce back and stay healthy.
10. Marine protected areas (MPAs) have been shown to completely prevent coral reef degradation.
11. Coral reefs are being restored through marine protected areas that are free from human interference.
12. Campaigns to raise public consciousness are crucial to coral reef conservation.
13. To save coral reefs, governments and non-governmental organisations are collaborating to promote sustainable practices.

PASSAGE 2: NEXT PAGE

The Evolution of Writing Systems

1. Writing systems have played an integral role in the development of human societies. The earliest forms of writing were simple pictographs, used primarily to represent objects and ideas. These early scripts were common in ancient civilizations such as Mesopotamia and Egypt, where they evolved into more complex systems over time. The development of writing allowed humans to record important information, create laws, and communicate across distances.

   In ancient Mesopotamia, the Sumerians developed one of the earliest known writing systems—cuneiform—around 3200 BCE. This system used wedge-shaped symbols pressed into clay tablets to represent ideas and sounds. Meanwhile, the Egyptians developed hieroglyphics, which combined both logographic and alphabetic elements to depict objects and actions. These scripts, although different, served the same basic purpose: to preserve information and ensure the continuity of knowledge.

The Advent of Alphabetic Systems

2. The Phoenicians, around 1000 BCE, revolutionized writing by introducing an alphabetic system that used symbols to represent individual sounds rather than entire ideas or objects. This alphabetic script, which consisted of 22 symbols, laid the foundation for the Greek alphabet, which was subsequently adapted by the Romans to create the Latin alphabet, the one most widely used today.

   Alphabetic systems proved to be more efficient than pictographic systems, allowing for easier communication and greater literacy. The simplicity of representing sounds with a finite set of characters meant that alphabetic scripts could be learned and used more quickly than other types of writing. As such, alphabetic writing spread rapidly across Europe, Asia, and Africa, replacing older systems in many regions.

Digital Revolution and the Decline of Traditional Writing

3. With the advent of the digital age, communication has undergone a dramatic transformation. The rise of computers, internet and mobile has made written communication faster and more accessible than ever before. Email, social media platforms, and instant messaging have become the dominant forms of written interaction, replacing traditional letters, telegrams, and even face-to-face communication.

   While digital communication has made information exchange more efficient, it has also had an impact on the way people write. Handwriting, once a crucial skill, has declined in importance as more people rely on digital devices to communicate. The rapid pace of texting, with its use of abbreviations and shorthand, has raised concerns about the erosion of traditional writing skills.

Preserving Written Languages

4. Alongside the digital transformation, there has been growing concern over the preservation of traditional languages and writing systems. With globalization and the dominance of English, many smaller languages and their associated scripts are at risk of extinction. Linguists and cultural organizations are working to document and preserve endangered languages, often through digital means such as online archives and language learning apps.

Efforts to digitize ancient and modern scripts have been crucial in preserving linguistic heritage. Many scripts, such as Sanskrit and Old English, are now accessible to the global population through online platforms. Furthermore, the study of ancient texts and manuscripts continues to provide valuable insights into the history and culture of past civilizations.

CHOOSE THE CORRECT LETTER A, B, OR C

14. What was the primary function of early writing systems like pictographs in ancient civilizations?

A) To represent sounds and pronunciation

B) To record important information and communicate across distances

C) To create alphabets and letters

15. Which writing system did the Sumerians develop around 3200 BCE?

A) Hieroglyphics

B) Cuneiform

C) The Latin alphabet

16. What innovation did the Phoenicians introduce to writing systems around 1000 BCE?

A) Pictographs

B) Alphabetic system

C) Logographic symbols

17. How did alphabetic systems compare to earlier pictographic systems?

A) They were less efficient and harder to learn

B) They were more efficient and allowed for greater literacy

C) They were used only in Europe and had no global impact

18. What has been one major impact of the digital age on communication?

A) Increased use of traditional handwriting

B) Written communication has become slower and less accessible

C) Written communication has become faster and more accessible

19. What concern is raised regarding traditional writing skills in the digital age?

A) Handwriting is becoming more important

B) People are no longer using digital devices

C) Handwriting is declining in importance due to digital communication

20. What efforts are being made to preserve traditional languages and writing systems?

A) Only oral storytelling is used for preservation

B) Linguists and cultural organizations are working to document and preserve them, often through digital means

C) Ancient scripts are no longer studied or preserved

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the text

TURE	**if the statement agrees with the information**
FALSE	**if the statement contradicts with the information**
NOT GIVEN	**if there is no information on this**

21. The earliest forms of writing were complex alphabetic systems.

22. The Phoenicians were the first to introduce an alphabetic writing system.

23. The Latin alphabet is the most widely used alphabet today because it was developed by the Romans.

24. Handwriting is becoming increasingly important as digital communication becomes more popular.

25. Efforts to preserve traditional languages involve using digital technology, such as language learning apps and online archives.

26. Globalization has led to the extinction of many smaller languages and writing systems.

PASSAGE 3:

Space Exploration: Benefits and Challenges

Space exploration has long captivated the imagination of scientists and the public alike. Since the first successful launch of Sputnik 1 by the Soviet Union in 1957, humanity has made significant strides in space technology. The Apollo moon landings, the creation of space stations, and robotic missions to distant planets have all contributed to expanding our knowledge of the universe. Despite these advancements, space exploration remains a complex and expensive endeavor, raising important questions about its costs, its benefits, and its future.

1. Technological Advancements and Innovations

One of the most significant benefits of space exploration has been the development of technology. Space missions have led to innovations that have transformed life on Earth. For instance, satellite technology has revolutionized global communication, weather forecasting, and navigation systems. The Global Positioning System (GPS), which relies on a network of satellites orbiting Earth, has become an essential tool in modern life. Moreover, space technology has led to improvements in materials science, medical equipment, and even household products. For example, the development of heat-resistant materials for spacecraft has been adapted for use in products ranging from firefighting equipment to non-stick cookware.

Space exploration has also contributed to advances in medical technology. The microgravity environment of space has been used to study the behavior of fluids and human cells, leading to innovations in medical devices and treatments. Space-based research has facilitated the development of diagnostic tools, such as portable ultrasound devices, which have been used in remote or disaster-stricken areas. Additionally, the study of the effects of space travel on human health has provided valuable insights into the treatment of bone density loss and muscle atrophy, conditions that also affect people on Earth, especially the elderly and those with certain health conditions.

2. Economic Impact and Space Industry Growth

The economic impact of space exploration is another significant factor in its continued support. While space missions are costly, they have generated long-term economic benefits. The commercial space sector, including satellite communications, Earth observation, and space tourism, has grown exponentially in recent years. Companies like SpaceX, Blue Origin, and Virgin Galactic have made space travel more affordable and have provided opportunities for private investment in space exploration.

In addition to private sector growth, the space industry has led to the creation of thousands of jobs in fields such as engineering, research, and manufacturing. The space industry has also contributed to the development of new technologies that have broader applications, such as advances in robotics and artificial intelligence (AI). Space exploration has thus played a key role in fostering innovation in various industries, spurring growth in high-tech sectors and encouraging international collaboration.

The potential for economic gain from space exploration is vast. In the near future, the mining of asteroids for valuable materials such as rare metals could become a profitable industry. Some experts predict that in the coming decades, space will become a critical source of resources, reducing Earth's reliance on terrestrial mining. Additionally, plans for commercial space stations and lunar mining missions could provide new revenue streams and create opportunities for economic growth beyond Earth.

3. The Challenges of Space Exploration

While the benefits of space exploration are clear, the challenges are equally formidable. One of the primary concerns is the immense cost of space missions. The development, launch, and operation of spacecraft are highly expensive, and many critics argue that these funds could be better spent addressing pressing issues on Earth, such as poverty, healthcare, and climate change. According to estimates, NASA's annual budget alone exceeds $20 billion, and private space missions are similarly costly.

The environmental impact of space exploration is another critical issue. Rocket launches contribute to atmospheric pollution, and the growing amount of space debris in orbit around Earth poses a risk to both current and future space missions. Satellite collisions and space debris could make certain orbits unsafe, complicating future exploration efforts. Additionally, the production and disposal of spacecraft and other space-related materials create their own environmental concerns. The ethical implications of space exploration are also under scrutiny. As humanity pushes further into space, questions arise about planetary protection and the potential for contamination of other celestial bodies. There are growing calls for international cooperation in developing guidelines for the responsible use of space, ensuring that exploration does not come at the expense of environmental preservation.

4. Ethical and Philosophical Considerations

Space exploration raises profound ethical questions that go beyond the technical and economic aspects. One of the primary concerns is the concept of "space colonization"—the idea of establishing human settlements on other planets. Proponents argue that colonizing other planets, particularly Mars, could ensure the survival of the human species in the event of a catastrophe on Earth, such as climate change or a large asteroid impact. However, critics point out that the resources required for space colonization could be better invested in solving problems here on Earth, such as poverty, hunger, and inequality.

There are also concerns about the impact of space exploration on indigenous life forms, should they be discovered on other planets or moons. The possibility of contaminating other planets with Earthly microbes, or introducing non-native species, has prompted calls for stringent planetary protection protocols. Some argue that humanity has an ethical obligation to ensure that its exploration of space does not harm extraterrestrial ecosystems, even if those ecosystems are currently unknown or uninhabited.

5. The Future of Space Exploration

Looking to the future, space exploration continues to evolve, with new missions and ambitions on the horizon. The development of reusable rockets, such as SpaceX's Falcon 9, has dramatically reduced the cost of space travel, and the prospect of human missions to Mars seems increasingly feasible. Scientists and engineers are working on technologies that would enable astronauts to live and work on Mars for extended periods, with the goal of establishing a permanent human presence on the Red Planet by the 2040s.

In addition to Mars, the Moon is expected to play a central role in future space exploration. NASA's Artemis program aims to return astronauts to the Moon by the mid-2020s, with the long-term goal of establishing a sustainable human presence on the lunar surface. The Moon could serve as a launch point for missions to Mars and other planets, providing a valuable platform for scientific research and resource extraction.

Moreover, space tourism, once considered a fantasy, is now becoming a reality. Private companies such as Virgin Galactic and Blue Origin have already launched suborbital spaceflights for paying customers, and future developments in space tourism could open up new possibilities for public participation in space exploration.

COMPLETE THE SENTENCE BELOW

Write NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS for each answer.

27. Space exploration has significantly advanced technology, resulting in innovations such as _____, GPS, and improvements in materials science and medical equipment.

28. The commercialization of space exploration, including _____ and space tourism, has contributed to the growth of the space industry, providing opportunities for private investment.

29. Space exploration has created thousands of jobs in _____, research, and manufacturing, contributing to the development of high-tech sectors like robotics and artificial intelligence.

30. Despite the benefits, space exploration faces significant challenges, including the high cost of missions and concerns over the _____ of rocket launches and space debris.

31. Ethical concerns surrounding space exploration include the potential harm to _____ ecosystems and the idea of space colonization as a means of ensuring humanity's survival.

32. The prospect of space colonization, especially on _____, has raised debates about whether resources should be spent on space exploration or addressing issues on Earth such as poverty and inequality.

33. The future of space exploration includes plans for human missions to _____ by the 2040s and the development of sustainable lunar missions, with the Moon serving as a launch point for Mars exploration.

34. Space tourism, once a distant dream, is becoming a reality with private companies offering _____ spaceflights for paying customers, opening up new possibilities for public participation in space exploration.

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the text

TURE **if the statement agrees with the information**

FALSE **if the statement contradicts with the information**

NOT GIVEN **if there is no information on this**

35. The primary concern of space exploration is space colonization to ensure the survival of humanity.

36. Critics argue that the resources needed for space colonization should be allocated to addressing issues like poverty and hunger on Earth.

37. There are no concerns regarding the impact of space exploration on indigenous life forms on other planets.

38. Humanity is not obligated to avoid harm to extraterrestrial ecosystems when exploring space.

39. The development of reusable rockets has made space exploration significantly more affordable.

40. The Moon will not play a role in future space exploration, and missions will solely focus on Mars.

IELTS WRITING

Writing Task 1: Academic (150 words, 20 minutes)

Task 1 (Table)

You should spend about 20 minutes on this task.

The table below shows the percentage of energy produced from different sources in Country A in 1990 and 2020.

Energy Source	**1990 (%)**	**2020 (%)**
Coal	40%	20%
Natural Gas	25%	30%
Nuclear	20%	25%
Solar	5%	15%
Other Renewables	10%	10%

Summarize the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant.

Write at least 150 words.

Writing Task 2: Essay (250 words, 40 minutes)

You should spend about **40 minutes** on this task.

Essay Prompt:

In many countries, it is becoming increasingly common for people to shop online instead of going to physical stores.

Do you think the advantages of online shopping outweigh the disadvantages?

Give reasons for your answer and include any relevant examples from your own knowledge or experience.

IELTS SPEAKING

PART 1: INTRODUCTION AND INTERVIEW

Duration: 4–5 minutes

Questions about You and Familiar Topics

1. **Work or Study:**
    - Are you working or studying at the moment?
    - Why did you choose this field of work/study?
    - What do you find most enjoyable about it?
2. **Free Time:**
    - How do you usually spend your free time?
    - Is there a hobby you've always wanted to try? Why?
3. **Holidays:**
    - What kind of holidays do you enjoy?
    - Do you prefer traveling alone or with others? Why?

PART 2: LONG TURN

Duration: 3–4 minutes (1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak)

Cue Card:

Describe **a skill you learned recently that you think is useful.**

You should say:

- What the skill is
- How you learned it
- Why you learned it
- And explain how this skill is useful to you.

Follow-up Questions:

- Do you enjoy learning new skills? Why or why not?
- Is it important to learn practical skills as well as academic knowledge?

PART 3: DISCUSSION

Duration: 4–5 minutes

Questions Related to the Topic in Part 2

1. **Importance of Skills:**
   - What are the most important skills for success in today's world?
   - Should schools focus more on teaching practical skills?

2. **Lifelong Learning:**
   - Do you think people stop learning new skills as they grow older?
   - What motivates people to learn skills later in life?

3. **Impact of Technology on Skills:**
   - How has technology changed the way we learn new skills?
   - Do you think traditional methods of learning skills will disappear in the future?

Answer Key

LISTENING

1. (40 and 60)
2. (December 29th)
3. (La Dolce Vita)
4. (The Grand Hotel)
5. (£18)
6. (Vegetarian lasagna)
7. (Pudding, tiramisu)
8. (£60)
9. (December 5th)
10. (The staff newsletter)
11. Students union
12. Practical aspects
13. Grants and fees
14. Nursery provision
15. Essay deadlines
16. Joining clubs
17. Jackie Kouachi
18. Marshall
19. 9: 30 am
20. 4: 00 pm
21. B) The impact of teamwork and collaboration on productivity
22. A) It suggests that people naturally gravitate toward specific roles based on their personality traits.
23. B) A balance of different personalities and skills
24. C) Conflicting working styles
25. B) Through training and experience
26. B) Team-building activities and workshops
27. A) Innovators who come up with creative solutions
28. B) They are crucial for managing differing working styles.
29. B) Team dynamics affect job performance and success
30. B) Greater productivity, innovation, and job satisfaction
31. Secondary
32. Wallpaper
33. Cone
34. Glue
35. Two-dimensional
36. Paper
37. White
38. Glue
39. Problem-solving
40. Constructivism

READING

14. Biologically
Location: Paragraph 1
Explanation: The passage refers to coral reefs as "rainforests of the sea" and mentions that they are among the most biologically diverse ecosystems on the planet.

15. Corals.
Location: Paragraph 2
Explanation: The passage states that corals belong to the phylum Cnidaria, confirming this statement as true.

16. Calcium carbonate
Location: Paragraph 2
Explanation: The passage explains that each coral polyp secretes calcium carbonate, which forms the hard exoskeleton of the reef.

17. Coastal erosion
Location: Paragraph 3
Explanation: The passage describes how coral reefs protect coastlines by absorbing the energy from waves and storms, reducing coastal erosion and tsunami impact.

18. Protecting.
Location: Paragraph 3
Explanation: The passage mentions that coral reefs generate approximately $375 billion annually from tourism, fishing, and services such as coastal protection.

19. **(True) Location:** Paragraph 3
Explanation: The passage mentions that coral reefs generate approximately $375 billion annually from tourism, fishing, and services such as coastal protection.

20. **(False) Location:** Paragraph 5
Explanation: The passage states that corals provide zooxanthellae with protection and access to sunlight, not the other way around.

21. **(True) Location: Paragraph 6**
Explanation: The passage explains that rising global temperatures have led to more frequent and intense coral bleaching events.

22. **(False) Location: Paragraph 6**
Explanation: The passage indicates that if bleaching persists for long periods, corals may die, leading to the collapse of reef ecosystems.

23. **(Not Given) Location: Paragraph 8**
Explanation: The passage mentions that marine protected areas (MPAs) help safeguard coral reefs, but it does not claim that they completely prevent degradation.

24. **(Not Given) Location: Paragraph 8**
Explanation: While MPAs help protect reefs, the passage does not state that coral reefs are being restored specifically through MPAs or by human interference being eliminated.

25. **(true) Location: Paragraph 10**
Explanation: The passage emphasizes the importance of public awareness campaigns in promoting sustainable practices to protect coral reefs.

26. **(True) Location: Paragraph 10**
Explanation: The passage mentions that governments and NGOs are working together to promote practices that protect coral reefs, such as reducing plastic waste and supporting sustainable seafood.

27. **Answer: B) To record important information and communicate across distances Location: Paragraph 1**
Explanation: The passage mentions that early writing systems such as pictographs were used to represent objects and ideas and allowed humans to record important information and communicate over distances.

28. **Answer: B) Cuneiform**
Location: Paragraph 1
Explanation: The passage explains that the Sumerians developed cuneiform around 3200 BCE, a writing system using wedge-shaped symbols pressed into clay tablets.

29. **Answer: B) Alphabetic system**
Location: Paragraph 2
Explanation: The passage states that the Phoenicians introduced an alphabetic system that used symbols to represent individual sounds, which revolutionized writing.

30. **Answer: B)** They were more efficient and allowed for greater literacy
Location: Paragraph 2
Explanation: The passage highlights that alphabetic systems were more efficient than pictographic systems, enabling easier communication and greater literacy.

31. **Answer: C) Written communication has become faster and more accessible Location: Paragraph 3**
Explanation: The passage discusses how the digital age, with the rise of computers, the internet, and mobile devices, has made written communication faster and more accessible.

32. **Answer: C) Handwriting is declining in importance due to digital communication Location: Paragraph 3.**

Explanation: The passage mentions that handwriting has declined in importance as more people rely on digital devices to communicate.

33. Answer: B) Linguists and cultural organizations are working to document and preserve them, often through digital means Location: Paragraph 4

Explanation: The passage explains that linguists and cultural organizations are using digital platforms, such as online archives and language learning apps, to preserve endangered languages and writing systems.

34. Answer: False

Location: Paragraph 1

Explanation: The earliest forms of writing were simple pictographs, not complex alphabetic systems. The passage clearly states that pictographs were used primarily to represent objects and ideas.

35. Answer: True

Location: Paragraph 2

Explanation: The passage explains that the Phoenicians revolutionized writing by introducing an alphabetic system that used symbols to represent individual sounds.

36. Answer: True

Location: Paragraph 2

Explanation: The passage mentions that the Greek alphabet, which was adapted by the Romans, became the Latin alphabet—the one most widely used today.

37. Answer: False

Location: Paragraph 3

Explanation: The passage states that handwriting has declined in importance as people rely more on digital devices for communication.

38. Answer: True

Location: Paragraph 4

Explanation: The passage clearly mentions that efforts to preserve traditional languages and writing systems include digitizing scripts and using platforms like language learning apps and online archives.

39. Answer: Not Given

Location: Paragraph 4

Explanation: While the passage mentions that globalization and the dominance of English put smaller languages and scripts at risk, it does not state that these languages and writing systems have already gone extinct.

40. (Answer: satellite communication)

Location and Explanation: In the section on "Technological Advancements and Innovations," the passage explains that satellite technology revolutionized communication, weather forecasting, and navigation systems like GPS, which rely on satellites in orbit. The advances also influenced various industries, including materials science and medical technology.

41. (Answer: satellite communication)

Location and Explanation: In the section on "Economic Impact and Space Industry Growth," the passage highlights how the growth of sectors like satellite communication and space tourism has provided new avenues for private investment, contributing to the expansion of the space industry.

42. (Answer: engineering)

Location and Explanation: The passage mentions that space exploration has led to job creation in fields such as engineering, research, and manufacturing, while also spurring innovation in high-tech sectors like robotics and artificial intelligence.

43. (Answer: Environmental impact)
Location and Explanation: In the "Challenges of Space Exploration" section, the passage discusses the environmental consequences of space exploration, including the pollution from rocket launches and the increasing risks posed by space debris, which endanger future missions.

44. (Answer: Extraterrestrial)
Location and Explanation: In the "Ethical and Philosophical Considerations" section, the passage highlights concerns about the impact of space exploration on possible extraterrestrial ecosystems and debates regarding space colonization for human survival in case of Earth-based catastrophes.

45. (Answer: Mars)
Location and Explanation: The passage mentions the ethical dilemma surrounding space colonization, particularly on Mars, where resources for space exploration might be better allocated to solving problems on Earth like poverty and inequality.

46. (Answer: Mars)
Location and Explanation: The passage, under "The Future of Space Exploration," discusses the goal of establishing a human presence on Mars by the 2040s, as well as using the Moon as a staging area for Mars missions.

47. (Answer: Suborbital)
Location and Explanation: In the "Future of Space Exploration" section, the passage highlights how private companies like Virgin Galactic and Blue Origin are already offering suborbital spaceflights for paying customers, bringing space tourism closer to reality and expanding opportunities for public involvement in space exploration.

48. Answer: True
Explanation: The passage mentions that one of the primary concerns of space exploration is "space colonization," specifically the idea of colonizing Mars to ensure human survival in case of catastrophic events on Earth.
Location: Paragraph 4

49. Answer: True
Explanation: The passage states that critics believe the resources for space colonization could be better invested in solving problems on Earth, such as poverty, hunger, and inequality.
Location: Paragraph 4

50. Answer: False
Explanation: The passage highlights concerns about the potential impact on indigenous life forms on other planets and moons, including the risk of contamination with Earthly microbes or introducing non-native species.
Location: Paragraph 4

51. Answer: False
Explanation: The passage suggests that some believe humanity has an ethical obligation to ensure that its exploration does not harm extraterrestrial ecosystems, whether they are known or unknown.
Location: Paragraph 4

52. **Answer: True**
Explanation: The passage states that reusable rockets, such as SpaceX's Falcon 9, have dramatically reduced the cost of space travel, making missions more feasible.
Location: Paragraph 5

53. **Answer: False**
Explanation: The passage explains that, in addition to Mars, the Moon is expected to play a central role in future space exploration, with NASA's Artemis program aiming to return astronauts to the Moon and establish a sustainable human presence there.
Location: Paragraph 5



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